

Hizbul Mujahideen

(HuM)

Founded in 1989

Chief MOHAMMED YUSUF SHAH AKA SYED SALAHUDDIN

Attacks July 10 IED blast killing 10 soldiers outside Srinagar

The largest terrorist outfit operating in Jammu and Kashmir, the HuM was founded as the militant wing of the Jamaat-e-Islami, reportedly at the behest of the ISI to counter the pro-independence stance of the Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front. The HuM favoured Islamisation of J&K and its integration with Pakistan. Its activities have so far remained confined to the Valley though the arrest of members from Kerala indicates that the group may be reaching out to the rest of India as well.

Indian Mujahideen

(IM)

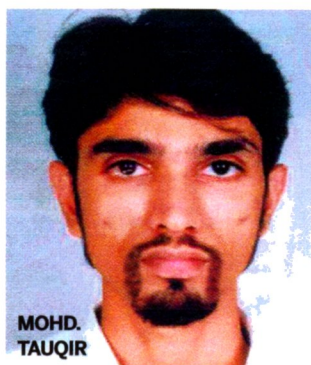
Founded in 2005

Chief AMIR RAZA KHAN

Attacks Varanasi, Delhi, Jaipur, Ahmedabad in 2008.

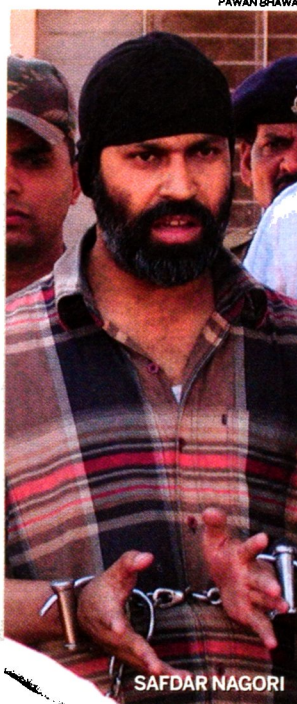
THE first home-grown terror network not only carried out a string of attacks in Jaipur, Ahmedabad and Delhi this year, killing over 100 persons but is believed to have been behind practically every other bomb attack since 2005, including the Mumbai train bombings and attacks in Hyderabad and Varanasi. It was founded by Amir Raza

Khan, a mobster from Kolkata who shifted base to Karachi and shuttles between Bangladesh, Pakistan and the Middle East. Khan founded the Asif Raza Commando Force which carried out the attack on the American Center in Kolkata in 2001 before founding the IM three years ago. The HuJI- and LeT-affiliated group was divided into various modules—the Shahbuddin brigade for strikes in south India and the Ghori brigade for attacks in the north. Key members like Atif Ameen were given training in weapons and explosives at LeT camps in Pakistan. One of the modules led by Ameen, executor of the Delhi blasts was neutra-



MOHD. TAUQIR

lised in the Batla House encounter in Delhi while the media module which sent out detailed e-mails after each strike, was rounded up in Mumbai and Pune. But with key operative Abdus Subhan aka Tauqir on the loose along with a dozen other IM members, including Jaipur-Ahmedabad-Delhi plotters Riyaz and Iqbal Bhatkal, the IM retains the potential to strike back at a place of its choosing.



PAWAN BHAWAR

SAFDAR NAGORI

Students Islamic Movement of India

(SIMI)

Founded in 1977

Chief SAFDAR NAGORI

Attacks Provided logistical support in 2006 Mumbai train blasts

WHEN it was banned in 2002, SIMI was always thought of as a radical Islamic organisation. However, in its years as an underground outfit, it had morphed into a movement which called for targeted killings of political leaders and had evolved a terror agenda. In March this year, the capture of the 'Nagori 13', a group of nearly 50 well-educated, highly-motivated middle class youth led by Safdar Nagori, revealed a group which fed recruits into other outfits like the LeT and HuJI and provided logistics for attacks. SIMI members also made up the Indian Mujahideen, showing just how amorphous the outfit had become.

The United Liberation Front of Assam

(ULFA)

Founded in 1979

Chief PARESH BARUA

Attacks Serial blasts in Assam, including the October 30 serial blasts which killed 89 people

ULFA is the classic case of an organisation that began to assert the rights of native Assamese playing into the hands of the ISI. A decade



PARESH BARUA

ago, ULFA members were already being trained in the ISI camps and were equipped by Pakistan to wage war against India. The organisation now has close links with other Islamic militant groups including the HuJI (B) with whom it is believed to have carried out the October 30 blasts—worst terror strike in the North east. In January 2007, the ULFA killed more than 60 Hindi-speaking migrant workers, of whom most were from Bihar. Currently, ULFA operates out of bases in Bangladesh and is hosted by its equivalent of the ISI—the Directorate-General of Forces Intelligence. *by Sandeep Unnithan*